

1598  
May 26  
Controller  
should not be  
a merchant

It was said by the Court that the Controller ought not to be a merchant, but that this is punishable in another course [? Court].

Jurisdiction  
of the Star  
Chamber,  
which is  
great

Ruled by the Court, that if any Judge, Justice, officer or subject of the realm shall go beyond his bounds and limits, and misdemean himself in any manner, this Court has power and authority to examine and punish this ; and this is clear law without any doubt or question.

1598  
June 28

**In Camera Stellata**, coram Consilio ibidem, Mercurij, 28 Junij, termino Trinitatis, Elizab. 40, An<sup>o</sup> Do<sup>ni</sup> 1598.<sup>1</sup>

Perjury  
referred to  
common law  
by reason of  
verdicts

All the four causes appointed to be heard this day did not come to sentence. One for perjury against five with whom two verdicts have past, and therefore it was referred for trial at common law by indictment or action on the statute. And because one had confessed the perjury, he was to be sentenced, but the Court respited him until the trial at common law, the other cross bill depending on this.

Perjury  
confessed  
and not  
sentenced

Cause dis-  
missed for  
insufficient  
bill

Another was compounded ; and the last for insufficiency and uncertainty of the bill for forgery, in which no certain time was limited, [was dismissed].

*Dedimus  
potestatem*  
will not be  
granted  
before  
contempt  
purged

Ruled by the Lord Keeper, that when contempt is committed, no *dedimus potestatem* shall be granted before the contempt be purged and answered.

LITTLETON  
p.  
LITTLETON  
In what case  
defendants  
may be used  
as witnesses

Also ruled in the case of Gilberte Littleton, the father, plaintiff, and John Littleton, his son, defendant, that if a plaintiff complain against several defendants for divers particular and several offences, and not [against] any two of them for one and the same offence, [one] defendant may use the [other] defendants as witnesses in all matters

<sup>1</sup> Eight Councillors and Judges were present.